growing military pressure will lead to their release tenable, if the military operations have to go on for months, which means no end to civilian casualties in the enclave? I admit to feeling hapless in the present conundrum.

What is sure is that the settler attacks against Palestinians in the West Bank have to stop, but nobody seems to lift a finger. And do we have to hear another idea from Knesset member Amihai Eliahu, who suggested dropping an atomic bomb on Gaza and had to be suspended for a month? Unfortunately, there is more than one madman in today's Israeli politics.

IDF ground forces in Gaza report seizing an important Hamas underground compound, killing a senior Hamas leader in the process.

South Africa recalled its ambassador from Israel. The growing diplomatic isolation of Israel among non-Western countries can be sustained as long as the United States has Israel's back. In Washington, the "progressive" segment of Democrats is as vocal as ever and threatens the president with dire results for his pro-Israel policy on election day. Such an outcome is tangible in a swing state like Michigan, with its population of 200,000 Arab Americans. Very few of them, according to researchers, would support Joe Biden today. In western Europe, Ireland and Norway are for the time being the only outspoken anti-Israel countries, Ireland more extremely, Norway with greater hesitation.

The US can demand that Israel be more pliant insofar as a humanitarian pause is concerned, but it cannot abandon its pro-Israel policy, because Israel's main enemies are also enemies of the United States. Thus, whether one likes it or not, the global context for relations between Israel and the US is a given.

IDF ground forces are in action close to Al-Shifa Hospital.

Tuesday, November 7